

Area of Study 6 – New Directions

The study of expressionistic, serialist, experimental and aleatoric music, as well as electronic music, is covered in this area of study, as well as several other styles.

In the set works, there is variety in terms of styles and also in instrumentation, including electronics in Saariaho's *Petals*. The combination of the set works and the musical pieces in Appendix 4 provides a good understanding of the rich diversity of musical styles in 20th-century music.

Set works

Students must study all set works in each area of study.

It is recommended that students familiarise themselves with each work as a whole, before learning to identify important musical features, context and/or elements of continuity and change between works.

Understanding of the musical elements, contexts and language will help to identify the historical, social and cultural contexts, and illuminate elements of continuity and change between the works.

Students need to learn how to write perceptively about music, in particular comparing, contrasting, assessing, evaluating and commenting, as appropriate.

The set works have been chosen to be representative of typical pieces from their areas of study. These pieces should be studied and analysed so that students have a good understanding of the stylistic features and conventions of each piece.

Students should be encouraged to express their ideas about the set works, using correct musical vocabulary.

Area of study	Set works
Vocal Music	• J. S. Bach, Cantata, Ein feste Burg, BWV 80: Movements 1, 2, 8 • Vaughan Williams, On Wenlock Edge: Nos. 1, 3 and 5 (On Wenlock Edge, Is my team ploughing? and Bredon Hill)
Instrumental Music	• Clara Wieck-Schumann, Piano Trio in G minor, Op. 17: movement 1 • Berlioz, Symphonie Fantastique: Movement I
Music for Film	• Danny Elfman, Batman Returns: Birth of a Penguin Parts I and II, Batman vs the Circus, The Rise and Fall from Grace • Bernard Herrmann, Psycho: Prelude, The City, Marion, The Murder (Shower Scene), The Toys, The Cellar, Discovery, Finale
Popular Music and Jazz	• Kate Bush, Hounds of Love: Cloudbusting, And dream of sheep, and Under ice • Beatles, Revolver: Eleanor Rigby, Here, there and everywhere, I want to tell you, and Tomorrow never knows • Courtney Pine, Back in the Day: Inner state (of mind), Lady Day and (John Coltrane), and Love and affection
Fusions	• Debussy, Estampes: Nos. 1 and 2 (Pagodes and La soirée dans Grenade) • Anoushka Shankar, Breathing Under Water: Burn, Breathing Under Water and Easy
New Directions	• Kaija Saariaho, Petals for Violoncello and Live Electronics • Stravinsky, The Rite of Spring: Introduction, The Augurs of Spring, and Ritual of Abduction

Suggested pieces of other music and unfamiliar pieces

Unfamiliar pieces in relation to question 5

Students should listen to and be able to appraise unfamiliar pieces of music as part of this component. Students can use the examples in Appendix 4 to support their preparation for appraising unfamiliar pieces of music or they may make their own selection of pieces of music to supplement the areas of study.

Unfamiliar music will have similar stylistic characteristics to the set works. Studying other pieces of music will help to provide breadth to support learning these stylistic characteristics.

Students will need to apply their appraising skills and knowledge of musical elements, contexts and language to these pieces of unfamiliar music in the examination. They should learn how to listen perceptively to unfamiliar music, developing their skills of aural analysis. In particular, they should be able to place the music in a wider context and chronology (which could include identifying the genre, composer and date of composition), recognise chords and keys, and complete aural dictation tasks.

The musical pieces listed in Appendix 4 for each area of study are designed to provide further examples of music from that period or musical tradition and provide breadth as well as depth to each area of study. These works provide a useful framework for appraising unfamiliar pieces. They are not compulsory to study.

Teachers may use the pieces listed in this appendix or they may make their own selection that relate to each area of study.

Other pieces of music in relation to question 6

The musical pieces listed in Appendix 4 for each area of study are designed to provide further examples of music from that period or musical tradition and provide breadth as well as depth to each area of study. These works provide a useful framework for a wider study of the set works. Their purpose is to show the common features of the set works in other music, so that each set work is not just seen in isolation. These are not compulsory to study.

Teachers may use the pieces listed in this appendix or they may make their own selection to supplement the areas of study.

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 2 hours 10 minutes.
- The assessment is marked out of 100 marks.
- There are two sections in the examination:

- Section B: 50 marks – one essay question on an unfamiliar piece of music (Question 5) and one essay chosen from four optional questions on a set work (Question 6).
- Students must answer all questions, with the exception of Question 6 which will give a choice of four options, of which students must answer one.
- The paper will include multiple-choice, short open and extended writing questions.
- Each student will have access to audio files and an individual audio player with the extracts of music relating to the exam, and will be in control of listening to the extracts relating to each question.